Punjab, most parts of Rajasthan and part of Gujarat and Thirunelveli in Tamil Nadu.

7. **Tropical dry evergreen forests**

This type of vegetation is found in areas where annual rainfall is in plenty but the dry season is comparatively longer. The trees are dense, evergreen, short and about 10 to 15 meter height. The common plant species are *Manilkara , Walsura, Diospyros and Memexylon* These types of forests are found in the eastern parts of Tamil Nadu, East coat of Andhra pradesh. They are also found in all coastal districts in Tamil Nadu from Thiruvallur to Nagapatinum districts.

III. Montane Subtropical Forests

This type of vegetation occurs in the areas with fairly high rainfall but where the climate is cooler than the tropical and warmer than the temperate forests. They are found in the altitude between 1000 m and 2000 m. The common plants are *Eugenia, Syzygium* and *Toona* are mostly evergreens. Many epiphytes including orchids and ferns are present. These are found in Nilgiri, Mahabaleswar, Assam and Manipur. In Eastern Ghats,it is found in the upper slopes and plateau of shervaroys, Kollimalai and Pachamalai of Tamil Nadu

These are further classified into

8. Sub-tropical broad leaved hill forests (Tamil Nadu,Kerala,Karnataka and Assam).

9. Sub-tropical pine forests (Punjab, U.P and a part of Sikkim)

10. Sub-tropical dry evergreen forests (Shivaliks and foot hills of western Himalayas).

IV. Montane Temperate Forests

This type of vegetation occurs where humidity and temperature are comparatively low. These forests are very dense with an extensive growth of grass and evergreen trees of 15 – 45 meters tall. The common plants are *Artocarpus, Balanocarpus, Pterocarpus, Myristica* and woody climbers besides ferns and epiphytes. It is also called mountain wet temperate forests. They are found in mountains of Himalayas. These are further classified into

11. Montane wet temperate forests.

12. Himalayan moist temperate forests.

13. Himalayan dry temperate forests.

In Tamil Nadu montane forest is mostly confined to moist and sheltered valleys, glens and hollows as in the Anamalis, Nilgiri and Palani hills tops at above 1000 m. They are known in Tamil as 'Sholas'. The common vegetation of sholas are *Ilex, Syzygium, Michelia, Eurya* and *Rhododendron*.

V Sub-Alpine Forests

14 Sub-Alpine Forests

This type of vegetation is found in the altitude ranging between 2900 m to 3500 m, where snow fall occurs for several weeks in a year with less than 65 cm annual rainfall. Hence, strong winds and below 0^0 C temperature prevail for greater part of the year. The common tree species are *Abies, Pinus, Betula, Quercus, Salix, Rhododendron* with plenty of epiphytic orchids ,mosses and lichens. They occur in Himalayas from Ladakh in the West to Arunachal in the East Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Assam, Jammu and Kashmir.

VI Alpine - Scrub

This type of vegetation is found in the Himalayas at an altitude ranging from 3600 m to 4900 m. The height of the trees decreases with increasing altitudes. The common plants are small sized plants such as *Sedum, Primula, Saxifraga, Rhododendron* , *Juniperus* and with many types of lichens. These are further classified into

15. Moist alpine scrubs

16. Dry alpine scrubs.

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